ETHNICS - Latinos

Tape 9B - George 1-26-76

Informant- Archiga

pp. 12-13
La Llorona narrative

Al. Like names like Smith and...People like that. I don't think there were any Serbians. No Croatians.

Au. Uh uh (negative) No. Probably Polish.

Al. Yeh, maybe...

Au. Uh huh (affirmative)

P. When I was here at Thanksgiving you told a story about la llorona.

Al. Yeh. Yeh.

P. How did that go? What was...

Al. You know, I ask...ask guys, you know, and they told me that--Here's what happens. Que--see, after these people got killed in the train accident, you know. After the people got killed in the train accident,..somthings happens in that--Because Cudahy was divided by the river. And a...they say thata--There was one lady--They was sisters. And a...one of the sisters was paralyzed, you know. That's what they told me. And a...these sisters were related to this Fierro family, the ones that were killed in the accident on the South Shore. Well a lot of people got killed with that South Shore in Cudahy. That's on Cline Avenue. But it was different then. It was just plain. There wasn't no overpass or anything like that. And a...they said that...one day one taxi driver---and I heard that--picked up a lady. On the other side in a taxi and took her over the bridge. I mean over the--At that time...it wasn't built yet but there was a bridge anyway, a small bridge. But when it went over the tracks... he asked her, I said, "Where am I supposed to take you?" And he looked around. She was gone. And that's when they start calling in reporters coming over, you know, and that.

Au. Because of that the guy got sick you know. Over that girl. Sick and scared.

Al. And they took him to the hospital.

P. Did they say it was la llorona or somebody else?

Al. Well, they called it la llorona.

Au. They call her la llorona, but...I...I...

Al. But it's not been heard--Somebody holler isn't...

Au. They say it's this girl that a--Do you know...?

Al. She appears on the bridge.

Au. Remember that day, onetime, we went to Cudahy? You went to fix a television in a house. I think it was Dr. Ramos' brother-in-law or something. You went to fix the television in Cudahy. About six or seven years ago. And the lady was telling us about this. She says that that girl, the one that appears with the white dress, appears to the man in the--taxi driver, was a girl that was going to be married. And she got killed. Some guy killed her beaause he was in love with her. She married somebody else, you know, On the day of her wedding and in every--everytime, on her, you know...en the day of, you know, of, the day of the anniversary,..the day she supposed to get married, she appears. That what she told me. That was this lady, you know, that guy's mother. I forgots what's her name. That was years back ago. That's what she told me. And they been living in Cudahy for many years. They said they knew the girl and everything.

But all that people moved. Some people moved on back to Texas and people move in Brunswick. Some here in Gary, some in Harbor, some went farther, you know. So, you hear many versions of one story, you know. You don't know which one to believe and to me it cling to my mind the first one I heard, you know. And I kind of...like to believe the first I heard, you know. It sounds more... more believable, you know, instead of the other ones.

P. How long did you live in Cudahy?

Al. Oh, we only live about nine months.

Au. Nine months. Uh huh. (affirmative)

P. Nine months is all?

Al. We lived there nine months because a...yeh, we were going to stay there longer...